

Business Requirement Document

E-Commerce Order Management Database System

Project Phase: Week 1 – Understanding the Business Problem

Role: Database Analyst

Document Type: Business Requirement Document (BRD)

1. Purpose of This Document

This Business Requirement Document (BRD) translates the business scenario of the E-Commerce Order Management System into a formal set of functional requirements, non-functional requirements, project scope, and assumptions/constraints. It is intended to be the reference point against which the database design and later implementation is validated.

2. Functional Requirements

2.1 Customer Management

- The system shall allow a new customer to register with Name, Email, Mobile Number, and Address.
- The system shall record the Registration Date automatically at the time of sign-up.
- The system shall allow a customer's contact details and address to be updated.
- The system shall prevent duplicate customer records using a unique Customer ID and Email.

2.2 Category and Product Management

- The system shall allow products to be grouped under a Category with a Category Name and Description.
- The system shall allow creation, update, and retrieval of Product records including Product Name, Price, and Stock Quantity.
- The system shall associate every Product with exactly one Category.
- The system shall track and update Stock Quantity whenever a product is ordered.

2.3 Supplier Management

- The system shall maintain a record of Suppliers with Supplier Name and Contact Information.
- The system shall support associating products with the supplier(s) that provide them for restocking purposes.

2.4 Order Management

- The system shall allow a Customer to place an Order that records Order Date, Total Amount, and Order Status.

- The system shall allow an Order to contain one or more products through Order Details, each with Quantity and Unit Price.
- The system shall calculate the Total Amount of an order from its Order Details.
- The system shall allow the Order Status to be updated (for example: Placed, Confirmed, Shipped, Delivered, Cancelled).

2.5 Payment Management

- The system shall record a Payment against an Order with Payment Method, Payment Date, and Payment Status.
- The system shall support common payment statuses such as Pending, Completed, and Failed.
- The system shall ensure a Payment record cannot exist without a corresponding valid Order.

2.6 Shipment Management

- The system shall record Shipment details for an Order including Delivery Address, Shipment Date, and Delivery Status.
- The system shall allow Delivery Status to be tracked through stages such as Processing, Shipped, In Transit, and Delivered.

2.7 Review Management

- The system shall allow a Customer to submit a Review for a Product with a Rating and Comments.
- The system shall associate every Review with both the Customer who wrote it and the Product it refers to.

2.8 Reporting

- The system shall support generation of reports such as sales by category, best-selling products, order status summaries, and customer order history.
- The system shall allow filtering of reports by date range, product, or category.

3. Non-Functional Requirements

Category	Requirement
Performance	The system should retrieve order, product, and customer information within an acceptable response time even as data volume grows.
Scalability	The database structure should accommodate a growing number of customers, products, and orders without redesign.
Data Integrity	The system must enforce referential integrity between related entities (e.g., an Order Detail cannot reference a non-existent Product or Order).
Security	Customer personal data and payment information must be protected from unauthorized access.
Availability	The system should be available for order placement and browsing during normal business operating hours with minimal downtime.
Reliability	Order, payment, and shipment data must remain consistent even in the event of partial transaction failures.
Usability	Data entry and retrieval structures should be designed so that reports and queries are straightforward to build.
Maintainability	The database schema should be well-documented and normalized to simplify future maintenance and enhancement.
Backup and Recovery	The system should support periodic backup of data to allow recovery in case of failure.
Auditability	Key transactions such as orders, payments, and status changes should be traceable through recorded dates and statuses.

4. Project Scope

4.1 In Scope

- Customer registration and profile record-keeping.
- Product catalog management organized under categories.
- Supplier record-keeping for procurement reference.
- Order placement covering multiple products per order.
- Payment record-keeping linked to orders.
- Shipment and delivery status tracking linked to orders.
- Customer review and rating submission for products.
- Basic business reporting drawn from the above data (sales, order status, top products).

4.2 Out of Scope

- Real-time payment gateway integration (only payment status record-keeping is covered).
- Third-party courier/logistics API integration (only delivery status record-keeping is covered).

- Marketing, promotions, discount coupon, and loyalty program modules.
- Multi-language or multi-currency support.
- Mobile or web front-end application development (this project is limited to the database layer).

5. Assumptions and Constraints

5.1 Assumptions

- Each customer registers with a unique email address before placing an order.
- Each product belongs to exactly one category at a time.
- An order must contain at least one product (via Order Details).
- Only one payment record is expected per order under normal conditions.
- Only one shipment record is expected per order under normal conditions.
- A customer can only review a product after it has been part of an order they placed.

5.2 Constraints

- Only the ten predefined core entities and their listed attributes may be used; no entities or attributes may be added, removed, or renamed.
- The database design must remain consistent with these entities throughout the semester (ER modeling, normalization, SQL implementation, and reporting).
- The project timeline follows a weekly deliverable structure, requiring requirements to be finalized before design work begins.
- The solution must be implementable using standard relational database technology.